Simmtronics and VIA team up to offer sub-₹10K desktop in India - the SIMM

Simmtronics, a leading manufacturer of memory modules in the Asia Pacific region, is also a fast growing non-Taiwanese motherboard manufacturer. It is also one of the rare Indian companies that actually manufactures computer components right here in India, exporting them to over 15 other countries across the world, including Pakistan, Dubai, and Ghana.

Working with VIA Technologies, a major fabless supplier of x86 processors and platforms that's been focussing on the low-power, cloud and mobile markets for the last ten years, Simmtronics has struck a partnership to assemble VIA PC-1 mainboards at their new Roorkee plant.

VIA's PC-1 initiative is apparently "aimed at enabling the next one billion people to get connected...with a focus on communication, education and information." Based on VIA's acclaimed and well-adopted energy efficient processors, the VIA Nano and VIA C7 processor families, PC-1 products offer OEMs and ODMs the chance to offer their customers low-cost and power-efficient products. Early adopters, apart from a plethora of Chinese and Taiwanese brands, include such giants as HP, Samsung, Acer, LG, IBM, Lenovo and MIT's OLPC.

Simmtronics is also joining these OEMs in developing end-user PC-1 products, from the SIMM PC to the SIMMBOOK, which use VIA processors and chipsets along with the Ubuntu operating systems to offer great value for money and a reliable, stable platform.

The SIMM PC will be hitting the market soon through Simmtronics' wide range of channel partners, and amazingly, will be priced at under ₹10,000 including a 15.6-inch monitor, keyboard, optical mouse, VIA C7-D 1.6 GHz processor, 512MB -1GB DDR2 RAM expandable up to 4GB, 250GB SATA HDD and Ubuntu OS. Looking at the specs, it would be fair to think this was the bare minimum required to provide a comfortable user experience.

While VIA Technologies has been the third leg in an already imbalanced computer chip race, it seems its future is not uncertain, with the company getting its hands dirty in many fields, from ARM-based SoCs to GPUs to motherboards solutions. It is aiming its energies at a future where the cloud and connected devices are everywhere, with the desktop at the centre. d

HP TouchPad tablet and tilting TouchSmart AIOs

HP's has revealed the company's long-awaited consumer tablet offering – the HP TouchPad. Sporting a 9.7-inch screen, the 13-mm thick TouchPad offers an XGA resolution at 1024x768 pixels, and weighs in at 740 grams – all of which, as well as the tablet's curved edges, neatly position it alongside the current generation iPad.

The TouchPad runs HP's latest version of Palm's mobile operating system – webOS 3.0 – which is Flash compatible. It's powered by a dual-core processor, a Qualcomm Snapdragon APQ8060 running at 1.2 GHz. Surprisingly, it has just 512 MB RAM. Two capacities are on offer, 16 GB and 32 GB, and its 6300 mAh is rated to provide up to eight hours of battery life. Wi-Fi only, 3G and 4G models are in the pipeline.

The tablet also has a 1.3 MP front-facing camera, integrated stereo speakers, a gyroscope and accelerometer, as well as A-GPS support (in the 3G model). As for app availability, there are about 8,000 apps in the ecosystem currently, of which legacy webOS applications will run limited to non-fullscreen mode on the TouchPad. All the popular ones will be ready by the time the tablet arrives though.

HP has also hinted that it would be bringing the touch-friendly webOS to upcoming TouchSmart PCs, and maybe, even a line of netbooks. HP also introduced its latest TouchSmart models recently, which it hopes will finally convert the all-in-one desktop world. Called the HP TouchSmart 610 and 9300, the former is a conservatively endowed AIO machine meant for home usage, and the latter is a tad bit more capable, meant for a business environment. d